

Unique Features Proposal for Next-Gen Healthcare Platform

Executive Summary

This document outlines 15 high-impact, market-differentiating features designed to surpass existing platforms like Practo. The core focus is on **price transparency, dynamic marketplace bidding, real-time hospital tracking, AI assistance, and financial flexibility** to secure a winning entry in the hackathon.

Core Differentiators Matrix

Category	High-Impact Features	Strategic Value
Marketplace & Pricing	Reverse Bidding, Off-Peak Pricing, Group Pooling	Drives affordability and fills unused clinic capacity
Transparency & Trust	Cost Estimator, Price Guarantee, Bill Uploads, Itemization	Eliminates hidden fees and builds patient trust
Operational Efficiency	Live Queue Tracker, Emergency Escrow	Reduces waiting room friction and admission delays
Smart Clinical Access	AI Symptom Matcher, Second Opinion Marketplace, Bundles	Enhances diagnostic access and care continuity

Strategic Feature Breakdown

1. Reverse Bidding / Custom Price Bidding System

- Concept:** Patients post a specific treatment requirement with a target budget (e.g., "Root Canal within ₹8,000").

- **Mechanism:** Nearby clinics receive notifications and can either accept or counter-offer with custom packages within a short timeframe.
- **Impact:** Transforms static directory browsing into an active, competitive healthcare marketplace.

2. All-Inclusive Procedure Cost Estimator

- **Concept:** Calculates true out-of-pocket expenses beyond basic consultation fees.
- **Mechanism:** Combines consultation, mandatory lab diagnostics, follow-ups, and base medications into a single guaranteed "Max Out-of-Pocket Estimate."
- **Impact:** Eliminates post-treatment bill shocks for patients.

3. AI Smart Symptom-to-Budget Matcher

- **Concept:** Conversational AI assistant mapping user symptoms and financial constraints to the right specialist.
- **Mechanism:** Users type symptoms and budget limits; the AI identifies appropriate specialties and filters available doctors within that price band.
- **Impact:** Prevents self-diagnosis errors while honoring user financial limits.

4. Live Queue Tracker & Real-Time OPD Status

- **Concept:** Real-time visibility into doctor availability and appointment queue.
- **Mechanism:** Displays live token status (e.g., "Token #14 currently in room; Your Token #18 estimated time: 11:35 AM").
- **Impact:** Directly solves hospital wait-time frustrations.

5. Insurance & Government Health Scheme Auto-Eligibility Filter

- **Concept:** Automated policy matching for instant cashless treatment filtering.
- **Mechanism:** Users upload insurance policies or health scheme cards to filter clinics offering guaranteed cashless coverage.
- **Impact:** Simplifies complex insurance coverage rules.

6. "Price Guarantee" & Refund Protocol

- **Concept:** Guaranteed price protection for patients.
- **Mechanism:** If a hospital charges above the platform's confirmed price, the platform automatically refunds the difference or provides account credit.
- **Impact:** Establishes strong patient trust and accountability.

7. Dynamic Off-Peak Hour Pricing ("Happy Hours" for OPD)

- **Concept:** Time-based discounted consultation slots.

- **Mechanism:** Clinics mark low-demand hours (e.g., 2:00 PM – 4:00 PM) at 30–50% discounts to fill open slots.
- **Impact:** Maximizes hospital room utilization while serving budget-conscious patients.

8. Group / Community Surgery Pooling

- **Concept:** Collective bargaining for scheduled procedures.
- **Mechanism:** Patients joining a pooled booking slot (e.g., for cataract or eye surgery) receive bulk discounts on operating theater and room charges once group thresholds are met.
- **Impact:** Brings group-buying power to elective medical procedures.

9. No-Cost EMI & Micro-Loan Instant Eligibility Check

- **Concept:** Integrated point-of-care medical financing.
- **Mechanism:** Displays monthly payment breakdowns (e.g., "₹1,250/month with 0% EMI") with an instant soft eligibility check.
- **Impact:** Reduces financial barriers for urgent treatments.

10. Peer-Verified Out-of-Pocket Bill Uploads

- **Concept:** Crowd-sourced bill verification and historical price transparency.
- **Mechanism:** Patients upload anonymized receipts, which are processed to display verified historical average costs for procedures.
- **Impact:** Delivers trustworthy price validation beyond subjective text reviews.

11. Multi-Hospital "Cost vs. Quality" Comparison Matrix

- **Concept:** Side-by-side analytical evaluation of medical providers.
- **Mechanism:** Compares up to 3 hospitals across Total Package Cost, Doctor Experience, ICU Bed Availability, and Average Length of Stay.
- **Impact:** Empowers data-driven patient decisions.

12. Emergency "Fixed-Price Escrow" Deposit

- **Concept:** Frictionless emergency hospital admissions.
- **Mechanism:** Patients pay a fixed deposit into escrow to reserve emergency beds instantly, preventing upfront counter demands.
- **Impact:** Minimizes critical care admission delays.

13. Doctor "Second Opinion" Fixed-Fee Marketplace

- **Concept:** Rapid, low-cost remote report reviews.

- **Mechanism:** Patients upload diagnostic reports for a written second opinion within 24 hours at a low flat fee.
- **Impact:** Saves time and travel costs for diagnostic validation.

14. "All-Inclusive Package" Price Breakdown Toggle

- **Concept:** Granular cost itemization interface.
- **Mechanism:** Expandable UI toggle detailing surgeon fees, bed/nursing rates, pharmacy estimates, and post-op visits.
- **Impact:** Provides 100% price transparency.

15. Doorstep Sample Collection & Tele-Consult Price Bundling

- **Concept:** Unified hybrid care packages.
- **Mechanism:** Single discounted bundle incorporating online consultation, home sample collection, and follow-up reviews.
- **Impact:** Offers seamless care continuity with fewer hospital visits.